NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Back Bay

Boston, Massachusetts

67.7

out of 100 · **SOLID CHOICE**

▲ TOP STRENGTH	**Transit**
▼ TOP WEAKNESS	**Housing**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Back Bay, a charming neighborhood nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, offers a unique blend of historic charm and modern convenience. Known for its picturesque brownstones and tree-lined streets, this neighborhood is a solid choice for professionals, families, and students alike, with a master score of 67.7 out of 100. The area's top strength lies in its unparalleled transit system, scoring a perfect 100, making it an ideal location for commuters and city explorers.

Despite its urban setting, Back Bay boasts a high quality of life with a variety of amenities at your fingertips. The neighborhood scores impressively in categories such as schools (81.7), restaurants (82.3), and the convenience of Bluebikes (94.0), ensuring that residents have access to excellent education, dining, and eco-friendly transportation options. However, the area's housing score is relatively low (29.5), indicating that potential residents may face higher housing costs or limited availability.

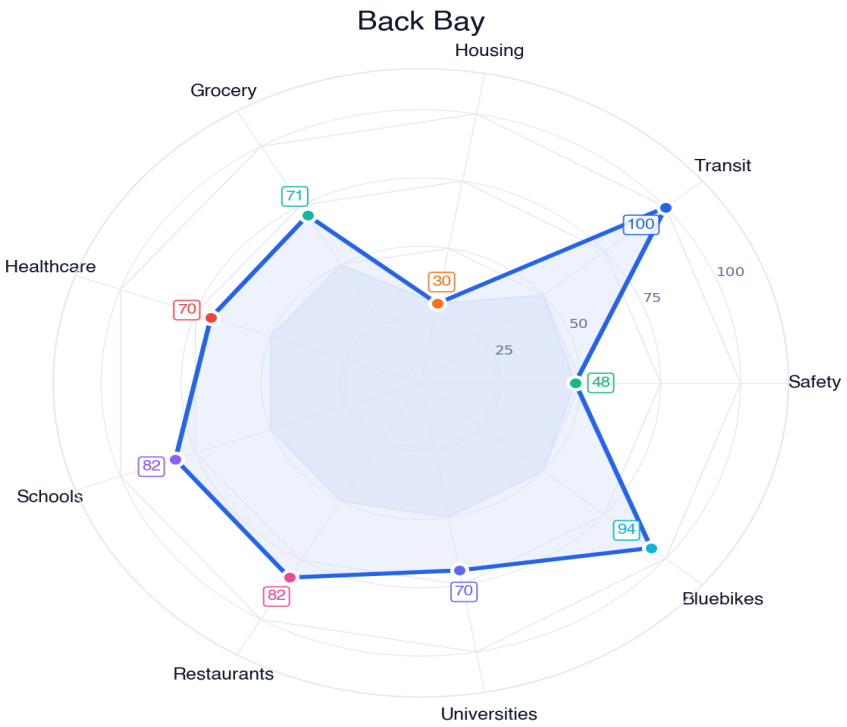
In conclusion, Back Bay is a vibrant and bustling neighborhood that caters to a diverse range of residents seeking a lively urban experience with easy access to top-notch amenities. While the housing market may present a challenge, the unbeatable transit options and rich cultural offerings make it an excellent choice for those who value connectivity and a dynamic lifestyle in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts.

DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	48.3	Moderate
Transit	100.0	Excellent
Housing	29.5	Premium
Grocery	70.8	Well Stocked
Healthcare	69.9	Good
Schools	81.7	Excellent
Restaurants	82.3	Excellent
Universities	69.7	Good
Bluebikes	94.0	Excellent

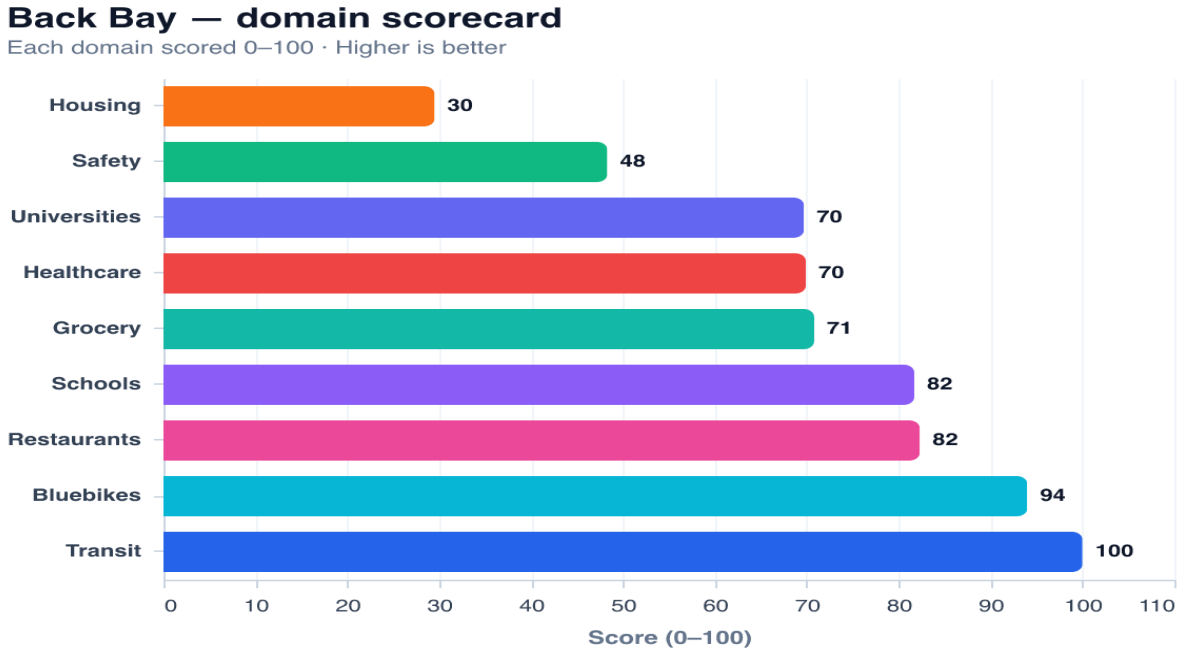
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

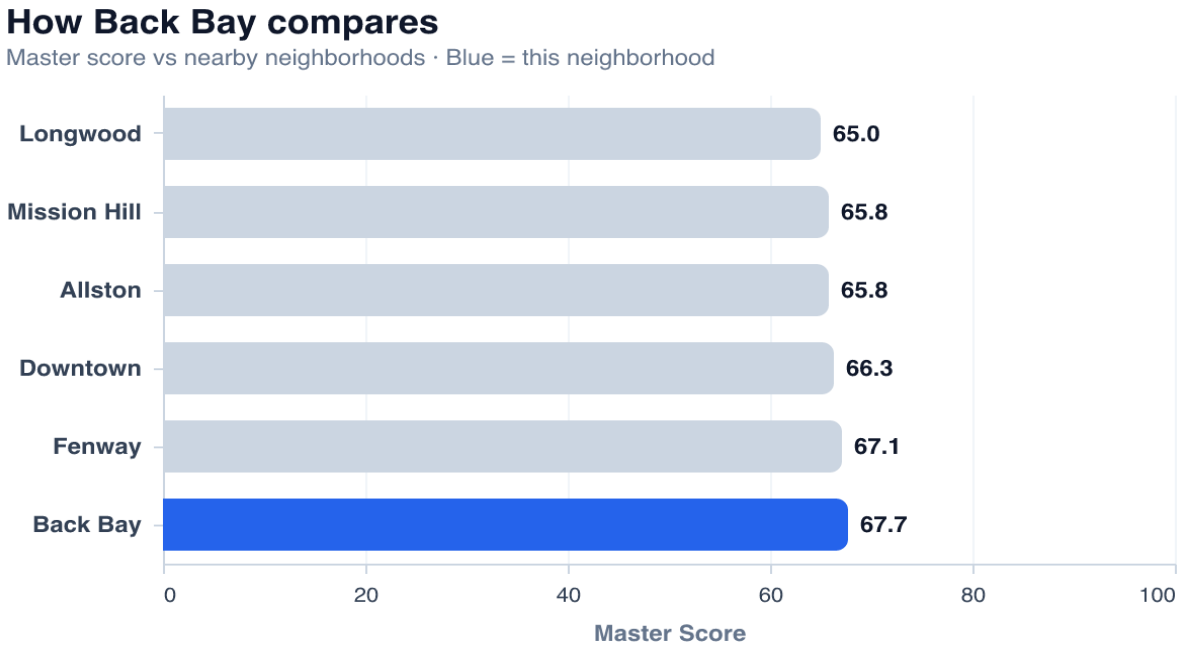
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher bars = stronger performance.

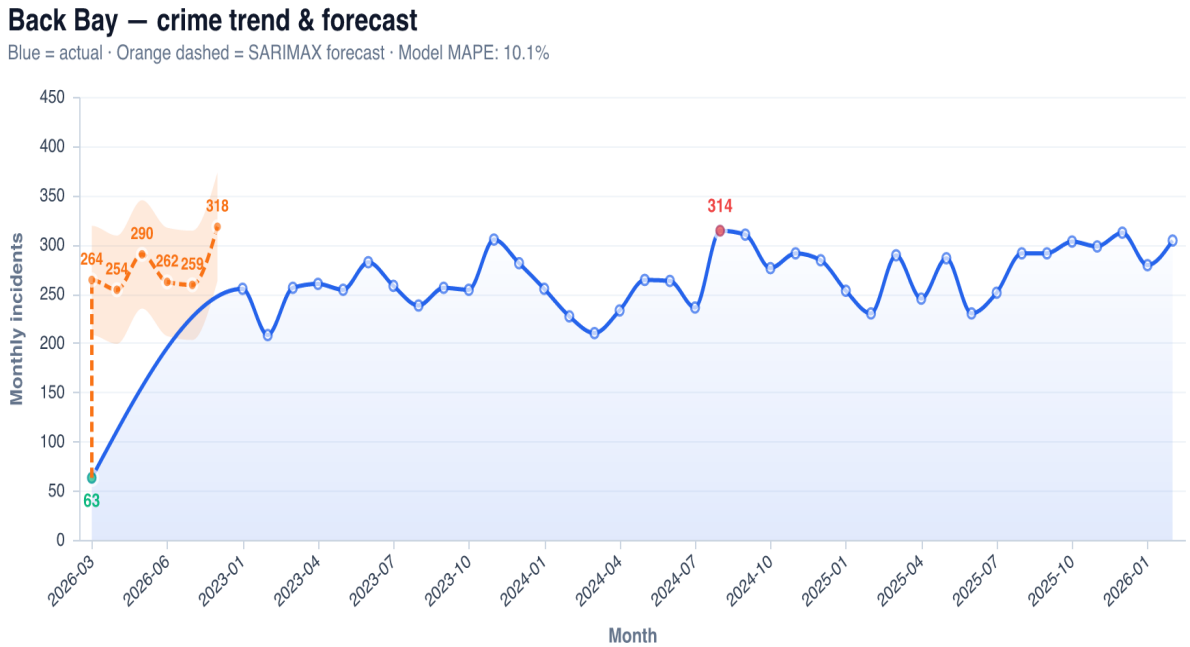
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · Compared to 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast



Blue = actual monthly incidents · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast with CI band.

Trend: Increasing · Model MAPE: 10.1% · Reliability: HIGH

Back Bay, a neighborhood in Boston/Cambridge, has seen an uptick in crime, averaging 298 incidents over the past three months, compared to 256 in the same period last year. Despite this increase, the ARIMA forecast predicts a slight decrease to 264 crimes by March 2026. Notably, 85.8% of these incidents occur within 21 dense crime hotspots, indicating a need for heightened vigilance in these areas.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

● Safety

Back Bay, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, has a moderate safety score of 48.3 out of 100, with a total of 10,195 incidents reported, equating to 16,443.55 incidents per square mile. The most prevalent crime type is larceny shoplifting. Notably, violent crime accounts for only 1.14% of incidents, while property crime makes up a significant 42.10%. There has been a concerning 6.13% increase in incidents year over year.

● Transit

Back Bay, Boston, boasts an excellent transit score of 100.0, offering a multitude of options for both rapid transit and bus services. The area is served by several MBTA lines, including the Green Line (B, C, D, and E branches) and the Orange Line, connecting to key destinations such as Arlington Station, Copley Square, and Kenmore Station. Additionally, there are numerous bus routes, with a total of 30 stops, providing access to various points of interest. Notably, 96.7% of these stops are wheelchair accessible, ensuring a convenient and inclusive transit experience for all.

Restaurants

Back Bay, a vibrant neighborhood nestled in Boston, Massachusetts, boasts an exceptional restaurant scene with a score of 82.3/100. It offers a rich variety of cuisines across eight categories, served in a dense concentration of 2437.1 eateries per square mile. The area's 1511 restaurants, rated on average at 3.73/5, provide a high-quality dining experience, with 41.6% falling into the excellent and good categories. The price mix caters to all budgets, with 150 budget-friendly options, 978 mid-range, and 376 upscale establishments, and a convenient 71.1% offering delivery services.

Universities

Back Bay, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers good access to higher education with a score of 69.7 out of 100. The area hosts three institutions, all of which provide bachelor's degrees or higher: Boston Architectural College, Fisher College, and New England College of Optometry. Notably, one of these institutions is a research university offering doctorate programs. Only one of these colleges provides campus housing. The educational categories represented include a graduate medical program, a liberal arts college, and a private college.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Back Bay, Boston's quintessential walking city, is a vibrant and dense neighborhood that offers a unique blend of residential, business, and cultural resources. Its strategic location allows residents to easily navigate the area on foot or by bicycle, with 74% of trips within the neighborhood being made without a car. The walkability of Back Bay is further enhanced by its inclusion in Boston's "Core" neighborhoods, along with Downtown, North End/West End, and Chinatown/Theater District. This core status means that nearly half of the trips starting in Back Bay also end within the core, creating a self-sustaining and interconnected community.

The daily life in Back Bay is characterized by a strong sense of community and a commitment to maintaining the neighborhood's quality of life. The city's Problem Properties Task Force plays a crucial role in this endeavor, addressing properties that have become chronic issues, whether they are centers of drug use and violence or simply visual blights posing safety hazards. By holding property owners accountable and empowering citizens to address quality of life issues, the task force ensures that Back Bay remains a safe and enjoyable place to live, work, and play. This commitment to preserving the neighborhood's character, combined with its walkability and rich array of resources, makes Back Bay a truly unique and desirable place to call home.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The neighborhood of Back Bay in Boston, Massachusetts, seems most suitable for young professionals. This is due to its excellent transit score of 100.0, indicating easy access to public transportation for commuting to work, and a high number of restaurants (score of 82.3) for socializing. The presence of universities (score of 69.7) also suggests opportunities for continuing education or networking.

2. Families might want to consider other neighborhoods, as the housing score in Back Bay is relatively low (29.5), suggesting limited or expensive housing options. Additionally, while the school score is decent (81.7), there may be other neighborhoods with better educational opportunities for children.